

pdfkit-table — Images in Cells

Sources: file path · base64 URI · Buffer · inline base64
Sizing: width · height · width+height · scale · fit · cover · align/valign

1. Source — file path (string)

Image	Code	Note
	<code>doc.image(filePath, x, y, opts)</code>	Reads from disk at render time
	<code>path.join(__dirname, 'npm-tile.png')</code>	Use <code>path.join()</code> for cross-platform paths

2. Source — base64 data URI "data:image/png;base64,..."

Image	Code	Note
	<code>"data:image/png;base64," + buf.toString("base64")</code>	PDFKit decodes to binary — base64 is NOT stored in the PDF
	Same string passed twice !' one XObject	PDFKit caches by string key — no duplication in the file

3. Source — Buffer (fs.readFileSync / fs.promises.readFile)

Image	Method	Note
	<code>fs.readFileSync(path)</code>	Sync — fine for CLI / build scripts
	<code>await fs.promises.readFile(path)</code>	Async — preferred in HTTP servers

4. Source — hardcoded inline base64 (no file needed at runtime)

Image	Use-case
	Embed tiny icons, watermarks or QR codes directly in your script or JSON config — no extra asset files required.
	Generate with: <code>Buffer.from(bytes).toString('base64')</code> or any online Base64 encoder. Supports PNG and JPEG.

5. Dynamic source — image path or URI stored in the cell value

Preview	Filename	Type	Size
	npm-tile.png	file path	1.3 KB
	npm-tile.png	base64 URI	1.7 KB (URI len)

6. All PDFKit image() sizing options

Preview	Option(s)	Behavior
	{ width: 48 }	Proportional to width — height auto-scales
	{ height: 44 }	Proportional to height — width auto-scales
	{ width: 60, height: 30 }	Stretch to exact size — may distort aspect ratio
	{ scale: 0.35 }	Scale proportionally by factor (35% of original)
	{ fit: [w, h], align: 'center', valign: 'center' }	Fit inside cell box — keeps aspect ratio (best for cells)
	{ cover: [w, h], align: 'center', valign: 'center' }	Fill cell completely — may crop image edges
	{ fit: [w, h], align: 'right', valign: 'bottom' }	Fit + snap to bottom-right corner of the cell
	{ fit: [w, h], align: 'left', valign: 'top' }	Fit + snap to top-left corner of the cell